

Assistant or on the Answer Wizard tab in the Excel Help window, and then clicking Search.

- m Query files and report templates: To use a query (.dqy) file to retrieve the data, open the query file (for more information, type 'create .dqy files' in the Office Assistant or on the Answer Wizard tab in the Excel Help window, and then click Search). To use a report template (.xlt) that doesn't already include a PivotTable report, open the template (for more information, type ways to share external data in the Office Assistant or on the Answer Wizard tab in the Excel Help window, and then click Search).
- m Parameter queries: To use a parameter query to retrieve the data, you must first create the parameter query (for more information, type create a query that prompts for criteria in the Office Assistant or on the Answer Wizard tab in the Excel Help window, and then click Search). Note that you can't create a parameter query to retrieve source data from OLAP databases.
- m Web queries: To use a Web query to retrieve data over the Internet, you must first create a Web query (for more information, type 'create a Web query' in the Office Assistant or on the 'Answer Wizard' tab in the Excel 'Help' window, and then click 'Search').

3.7.2.2.3 Prepare data from Multiple Consolidation Ranges

There are a few things to consider in preparing data from multiple Excel lists:

- m Make sure the lists are well organised: Again, neatness counts. For example, make sure the lists have matching row and column names for items you want to summarise together.
- m Remove all automatic totals: The PivotTable report will calculate the subtotals and grand totals for you.
- m If you plan to add more data later, create named ranges: Then, when you create the PivotTable report, make sure to specify the named ranges. That way, whenever you add more source data, you can update the PivotTable report to include the new data.